

Relationships, Sex and Health Education Policy

Growing in Christ. Thriving in Learning. Shaping the Future.

Version 2 · August 2026 · for adoption before 1 September 2026 · next review July 2027

This policy replaces the Relationships and Health Education Policy written in May 2025, which was built on the 2019 statutory guidance and reached its review date in May 2026. Appendix 2 sets out what has changed and why.

1. Status, scope and legal basis

This policy is written against the Department for Education's statutory guidance **Relationships Education, Relationships and Sex Education (RSE) and Health Education, published July 2025**, which comes into force on **1 September 2026** — the same date the school's own programme, Growing in Christ, launches. It replaces the 2019 guidance.

What is compulsory for us. As an independent school, Emmanuel is regulated by the Education (Independent School Standards) Regulations 2014. Two separate paragraphs apply.

Paragraph 2A requires the school to ensure that every pupil receiving primary education is provided with **Relationships Education**, and every pupil receiving secondary education with **Relationships and Sex Education**. This is compulsory, and we must have regard to the Secretary of State's guidance in providing it.

Paragraph 2(2)(d) requires the school to provide "personal, social, health and economic education which (i) reflects the school's aim and ethos; and (ii) encourages respect for other people, paying particular regard to the protected characteristics". **Health is named in that standard.**

Health Education as a separate statutory subject — created by the 2019 Regulations, which made it compulsory in maintained schools, academies and non-maintained special schools — does **not** apply to independent schools. That is a point about which regulation binds us, not about whether health is taught here.

So our position is this. We are required to provide PSHE including health, and we are not separately bound by the Health Education subject regulations. We therefore use the statutory Health Education content in the July 2025 guidance as our benchmark for discharging the PSHE duty, because it is the clearest available statement of what pupils need to know and be able to do. **The choice we are making is about method and standard, not about whether to teach health at all.** A curriculum that taught relationships without wellbeing, safety and physical health would in any case be incoherent.

This matters for inspection as well as for accuracy. ISI examines physical and mental health and emotional wellbeing, and looks for a PSHE curriculum that reflects the school's ethos and encourages respect for others with particular regard to the protected characteristics. Meeting the statutory Health Education content is how we evidence that we meet paragraph 2(2)(d) well rather than minimally.

This policy covers all pupils from Reception to Year 11 and applies to all staff who teach any part of the programme.

2. Our Christian foundation

As a Christian school we believe all teaching must sit within the whole context of our faith in God, who reveals Himself in Jesus Christ. In relationships and sex education we place the emphasis on the formation of respectful, loving relationships between friends and within families. Four convictions carry the programme.

Made in God's image

God made humanity in His own image, male and female (Genesis 1:26–27), and created us to live in relationship with Him. Sin broke that relationship, but we remain loved, valued and precious to God, and a restored relationship is possible through the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ. He has given every person immense dignity and worth as His image-bearers and as those He was willing to die for. That knowledge produces a deep respect for others.

Loving relationships

Relationships are God’s idea and His design, as are marriage and sex. God has lived in perfect loving relationship within the Trinity for all eternity and created us to enjoy relationship with Him and with each other. Our selfishness and sin get in the way, and relationships get damaged — so pupils are also taught how to mend them, in the ordinary contexts of school, family and church.

Marriage

We teach that God defined marriage as a lifelong covenant between one man and one woman (Matthew 19:4–6), a shared commitment of loyalty and closeness into which the gift of life may be brought. Our main focus is to explore what the Bible teaches about marriage, sex and relationships. Sexual abstinence before marriage is taught as God’s best for us, within the range of views pupils will encounter. **Singleness is honoured alongside marriage**, as Scripture honours it (1 Corinthians 7); a programme that presents marriage as the only good outcome misrepresents the Bible and fails the pupils who will not marry.

Identity

The Bible teaches us to find our identity in Christ rather than in our sexuality, gender, marital status or job. These may be aspects of a person’s identity but they are not what defines a Christian. We support pupils as they explore who they are and where they fit, and encourage them to know Jesus for themselves.

None of this is ever assessed. We assess knowledge, understanding and application. A pupil who does not share the school’s beliefs can achieve the highest outcomes by explaining them accurately and engaging with them thoughtfully. A pupil’s personal faith, spiritual state or private agreement with Christian teaching is never assessed, recorded or reported.

3. The seven principles of the 2025 guidance

The guidance sets out seven principles for effective RSHE. We have written our provision against each.

Principle	How we meet it
Pupil engagement	Content is pitched to what pupils actually face. Lessons use realistic scenarios and application rather than information delivery, and every unit ends in an assessed outcome that requires pupils to apply what they have learned
Parental engagement	Documented consultation (Appendix 1), curriculum materials available to parents on request, advance notice of sensitive units, and an annual information session
Positivity	The programme teaches what good relationships look like, not only what to avoid. Risk and harm are taught in a frame of hope rather than fear
Careful sequencing	Seven strands with published end-of-phase expectations from Reception to Year 11, so each topic lands on prepared ground. Age-sensitive content specifies the year group, not just the phase
Relevance and responsiveness	The programme is reviewed each July against current guidance and the year’s teaching, and adjusted where pupils’ actual questions and circumstances require it
Skilled delivery	Staff training at INSET and termly follow-ups. Suicide prevention and the law on sex and gender are flagged for specialist-informed training before they are taught
Whole-school approach	Content is reinforced through assemblies, the behaviour culture, Computing, Business Studies and Media Studies, so pupils meet the same ideas from several directions

4. What we teach, and when

From September 2026, RSHE is delivered through **Growing in Christ**, the school’s own programme, across seven strands: identity and belonging; character and wisdom; relationships, family and sexuality; physical, emotional and spiritual wellbeing; safety and digital life; stewardship, money and work; and community, citizenship and justice.

Phase	Years	Class	Delivery
EYFS	Reception	Willow	Through the EYFS framework — PSED and Physical Development, planned against the Early Learning Goals including Building Relationships
Phase 1	Y1–2	Willow	Rolling cycle, six units a year, taught alongside Reception provision
Phase 2	Y3–4	Hazel	Rolling cycle
Phase 3	Y5–6	Oak	Rolling cycle. Puberty is taught to Years 5 and 6 together — the class is not split (see §5)
Phase 4	Y7–8	Maple	Rolling cycle
Phase 5	Y9	Birch	Year-specific programme
Phase 6	Y10–11	Ash and Cedar	A linear two-year programme, not a cycle: Year 10 content in Ash, Year 11 content in Cedar. The withdrawable sex education component sits in Year 11

The full statutory mapping — every topic in the 2025 guidance against strand, phase and unit — is held in the Growing in Christ RSHE Statutory Coverage Grid, maintained alongside this policy and available to parents and governors on request. Where content is age-sensitive, the curriculum specifies the year group rather than only the phase, and units include split-teaching guidance for mixed-age classes.

5. Age and stage: what is taught at what age

The 2025 guidance sets no rigid age limits. It requires teaching to be age- and stage-appropriate, responsive to what pupils actually face. Our decisions about what is taught when are informed by the parental consultations recorded verbatim at Appendix 1, and by the content the school is required to cover.

Where the two are compatible — which is nearly always — the parental position governs. Where a statutory requirement means something must be taught earlier or more fully than the consultation suggested, we teach it, and we say so here rather than leaving parents to find out later. Both cases are set out below.

What is taught	When	Basis
Personal safety in all its forms; body privacy and the NSPCC PANTS rule; consent at an age-appropriate level; “keep your hands to yourself” as respect for personal boundaries; knowing you have a voice and how to use it if you feel in danger	From Reception, age 4 upwards	Parents, March 2025: “Safety in all forms and consent should be taught from age 4+”
No sexual content in the Lower School. The school teaches no primary sex education beyond the statutory curriculum	Reception to Year 4	Parents, March 2025: “Not appropriate to teach sexual content at this age”
Families take different forms — including families with same-sex parents — taught simply, with the emphasis that what matters most is that children are loved and cared for, within our Christian ethos (§8)	Lower and Middle School	Statutory Relationships Education. This goes earlier than the consultation’s answer on LGBT content; see the note below
Puberty, changes to the human body, and the beginning of sex education	Years 5 and 6	Parents, March 2025

What is taught	When	Basis
Puberty is taught to Years 5 and 6 together. The class is not split by year group.	Oak	Parents, March 2025, explicitly: teach it at Year 5 and 6 “and not to split the class up”
Menstrual wellbeing and the menstrual cycle, taught to all pupils	From Year 5	Statutory Health Education content, which applies to all pupils rather than to girls only. See the note below
LGBT content introduced. Where a younger child asks a question, it is handled sensitively and biblically rather than deferred	Around ages 10–11 (Year 6)	Parents, March 2025: “It can be introduced around the ages of 10/11”
Intimate heterosexual content, and the existence of other sexual orientations understood through a biblical lens	Middle School	Parents, March 2025
Transgender and gender identity, taught as set out at §10	Not before Key Stage 3	Parents, March 2025: “Transgender should not be referred to until KS3 and taught from the perspective of God”
The full range of relationships including LGBT, always through a biblical worldview; Christian marriage and its purpose; sex as God’s gift and what has been done to distort it, including pornography; how boys and girls should treat one another	Upper School	Parents, March 2025
Sex education proper — intimate sexual relationships, contraception, sexual health. This is the withdrawable component	Year 11 (Cedar)	Placed so that the withdrawal window aligns with the pupil’s own right to opt in from three terms before turning 16 (§12)
Mental wellbeing taught from a biblical viewpoint, with prayer and honest lament taught as responses alongside evidence-based strategies. Zen meditation and mindfulness practices are not used. There is no shame attached to mental health difficulty	Throughout	Parents, March 2025: “Yes, from a Biblical viewpoint. No meditation (Zen) or mindfulness practices. Our well-being comes from our creator... No shame attached to mental health issues”

Two notes of honesty

Where statutory duty goes further than the consultation. Parents suggested LGBT content be introduced around ages 10–11 and that relationships and LGBT issues wait until Upper School in the main. Statutory Relationships Education requires primary pupils to learn that families take different forms, including families with same-sex parents. The school has taught this in Lower and Middle School since the previous policy, and continues to. It is taught simply, kindly and within our convictions, and no child is left feeling their family is wrong. We record the difference here rather than obscure it: consultation genuinely shapes this policy, but it cannot override a statutory requirement, and parents are better served by being told that plainly.

One change we have made to our own practice. The consultation recorded menstruation as being taught to girls from Year 5 or 6. Statutory Health Education requires that all pupils are taught about menstrual wellbeing, not girls alone. From September 2026 it is taught to the whole class. Boys who understand menstruation are better brothers, husbands and colleagues, and girls are not well served by it being treated as a private matter for them to manage alone.

6. Content new or strengthened in the 2025 guidance

The following are additions or substantial strengthenings compared with 2019. All are now placed in the programme.

Topic	Where it lands
Online safety, AI and image-based abuse — deepfakes, AI-generated imagery and its criminal aspects, fake accounts, AI chatbots	Safety and digital life strand from Phase 3 upward, deepening at Phases 4–6; reinforced in Computing and Media Studies
Misogyny, violence against women and girls, and positive masculinity	Named units at Phases 4–6 (see §9)
The influence of pornography on attitudes, and how it disempowers women	Phases 5–6, taught factually and without sensationalism
Vaping	Primary at Phase 3 and secondary at Phase 5, alongside drugs, alcohol and the law
Suicide prevention and self-harm awareness	Phases 5–6 only, delivered under the guidance’s safe-teaching requirements: no methods, no sensationalising, signposting given, DSL briefed before teaching, follow-up route planned
Legal literacy — the Online Safety Act, criminal responsibility, Gillick competence	Threaded through Phases 4–6; each relevant unit carries a legal-facts section
Sex, gender and the law	Phase 5, revisited at Phase 6 (see §10)
Financial harms, gambling and fraud	Stewardship, money and work strand at Phases 4–6
Personal safety, including knife crime and serious violence	Phase 5
Loneliness and belonging	Wellbeing strand from Phase 2

7. How we teach contested issues

Three rules govern every lesson where the school’s convictions and prevailing views differ.

We teach our convictions clearly, and we say that they are convictions. Pupils should never be unclear about what the school believes, and never confused about the difference between a belief and a fact.

We teach the law accurately, including where it differs from what we believe. Pupils leave knowing what the law of England actually says. Misrepresenting it would fail them and would breach the guidance.

We do not present contested views as established fact — anyone’s. The 2025 guidance requires this, and it applies evenly. Where a question is genuinely disputed, pupils are told that it is disputed and taught what the different positions are.

One distinction needs stating, because the third rule can be misread. The school teaches its convictions as **true** — they are what we believe Scripture teaches, and Scripture is our final authority. We call them convictions because they are the school’s confessed position, not because we hold them uncertainly. What the third rule prevents is something narrower: presenting as settled fact those questions on which thoughtful people genuinely differ and on which Scripture does not clearly speak. Teaching a conviction plainly, and being honest about what is disputed, are not in tension.

Teachers may express their own view sensitively and professionally, since pupils will ask, and are expected to hold to the school’s convictions as set out in this policy. Pupils are never criticised for the views they hold. Where a pupil expresses hatred or prejudice — for example language that is racist, sexist, homophobic or transphobic — it is explained why that is not acceptable and why it will not be tolerated. Disagreement is not prejudice, and the difference is taught.

8. Families, sexual orientation and same-sex relationships

We teach that families are given by God for love, care and security. We recognise that families look different: some pupils live with a mother and father, some with one parent, some with grandparents or carers, and some with two

mothers or two fathers. Pupils are taught that all families are to be respected and valued, because what matters most is that children are loved and cared for. We explain that we believe God's design for family is shown in the Bible, while showing kindness and respect towards all people and the families they belong to. No child should feel excluded or devalued because of their family background.

Pupils are taught that the Marriage (Same Sex Couples) Act 2013 extends civil marriage to same-sex couples in England and Wales. LGBT content is integrated into the programme at a timely point rather than delivered as a stand-alone lesson, as the guidance requires. It is taught sensitively and with regard to pupils' age and maturity. Pupils learn that there are different kinds of relationship, and that as Christians we believe we should live in accordance with what the Bible teaches. Sensitivity and respect are shown for all people, whether married, unmarried or in same-sex relationships, and teaching is planned so that pupils — whatever their developing attractions — find that it meets their needs rather than excludes them.

9. Misogyny, violence against women and girls, and positive masculinity

This is a major addition in the 2025 guidance and requires named units rather than passing mentions.

Much of it is addressed to boys and young men, and we do not soften that. Pupils are taught to recognise misogyny, to understand its link to violence against women and girls, and to see how sexualised media and online content shape attitudes and disempower women. Boys are taught that there is no room whatsoever for violence, contempt or hatred towards women, and that a man's strength is for the protection and service of others — "Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ also loved the church and gave Himself for her" (Ephesians 5:25), a text about self-giving rather than authority. Consent, coercive control and the law are taught explicitly.

Separately — and deliberately not in the same unit — all pupils are taught to resist cultural pressure about appearance, and to be secure in how God made them rather than conforming to what they are told to look like. This is body-image and identity teaching. It is kept apart from teaching on harassment and abuse so that no pupil could infer that how a person presents themselves bears on whether they are mistreated. Responsibility for abuse lies with the person who commits it, and pupils hear that stated.

Men and women are of equal value and worth to God. Pupils are encouraged to consider the differences between the sexes, the strengths of each, and how they complement one another according to God's design, and at an appropriate age to compare that with what the surrounding culture and other religions teach.

10. Sex, gender and the law

We teach that God created humanity male and female, and we teach this clearly as the school's conviction.

Pupils are taught, as fact: that biological sex is a matter of biology; that gender reassignment is a protected characteristic under the Equality Act 2010; and what the law does and does not require. In line with the 2025 guidance, contested beliefs about gender identity are not presented as established fact, and pupils are taught which questions are genuinely disputed and what the different positions are. This requirement protects the school as much as it constrains it.

Where a pupil is affected personally. Any expression by a pupil regarding their gender identity is taken seriously, thoughtfully and considerately. It is dealt with in the first instance as a pupil welfare matter, and as a safeguarding matter where indicated, involving the Designated Safeguarding Lead. Parents are involved from the outset; decisions affecting a child's welfare are not the school's to take alone. Every pupil is supported through the ups and downs of physical and emotional development and should feel neither rejected nor ostracised. No form of bullying is tolerated, and this includes bullying on the basis of gender identity.

This section should be reviewed by an adviser with current expertise in independent-school law before adoption. It is the section of this policy most likely to be scrutinised, the legal and regulatory position continues to develop, and the school should be confident it is on current ground rather than on 2017 ground.

11. Parents

Consultation

This policy has been developed in consultation with parents. Meetings were held in October 2019 and March 2025, and the responses gathered are recorded verbatim at Appendix 1. A further documented consultation takes place in the autumn term of 2026 on this version, before trustee adoption, meeting the 2025 guidance's strengthened expectation of proactive engagement.

Transparency of materials

All curriculum materials are made available to parents on request, and we respond positively to such requests. This is a requirement of the 2025 guidance and we regard it as reasonable: parents are entitled to know what their children are taught. Parents are informed in advance when sensitive units are taught, and an annual information session is offered. Requests are made to the Headteacher.

Parents do not have a veto over curriculum content. Where a parent disagrees with what is taught, we will meet them, explain our reasoning, and listen to theirs.

12. The right to withdraw

This section corrects a description in the previous policy which was wider than the law allows.

Position	
No right of withdrawal	Relationships Education (primary), Health Education including puberty, and the relationships elements of secondary RSE. Also the human-reproduction content of the national science curriculum
Right of withdrawal applies	The sex education elements of RSE. At Emmanuel this is the Phase 6 unit <i>Sex, health and wisdom</i> , taught in Year 11, covering intimate sexual relationships, contraception and sexual health. The school teaches no primary sex education beyond the statutory curriculum
Primary	Where a request is made, the Headteacher grants it
Secondary	The Headteacher grants the request other than in exceptional circumstances, and will discuss it with the parent first
The pupil's own decision	From three terms before the pupil turns 16, a pupil who wishes to receive sex education rather than be withdrawn may say so, and the school will make arrangements for them to receive it

Requests are made in writing to the Headteacher and are recorded. Alternative purposeful provision is arranged for any pupil withdrawn.

13. Safeguarding, confidentiality and answering questions

Effective RSHE, which brings an understanding of what is and is not acceptable in a relationship, may lead to a disclosure. Staff inform the Designated Safeguarding Lead in line with the school's child protection procedures, and record in CPOMS. **No member of staff promises confidentiality where a concern exists.** Every unit plan carries a safeguarding note and a DSL prompt.

Answering pupils' questions. Difficult questions are not dismissed but addressed sensitively. Where a question relates to a widely held Christian belief, it is good practice to begin "In general, Christians believe that... because...". Where a question is not appropriate for the whole class, it may be answered separately with the pupil, and staff may speak with parents where they judge the question is not age-appropriate. Upper school pupils are encouraged to read the relevant passages and think issues through for themselves.

14. Pupils with special educational needs

RSHE is accessible to all pupils. Content is adapted, not reduced: pupils with SEND are more likely, not less, to need teaching on consent, exploitation, personal safety and healthy relationships, and the guidance is clear that this content should be tailored rather than withheld. Adaptation is planned with the SENDCo and recorded in unit plans, and takes account of a pupil's understanding, communication and any vulnerability.

15. Monitoring, evaluation and assessment

The Governing Body has appointed a named governor with responsibility for RSE. This governor meets the RSE lead each term to review teaching and learning, which may include lesson visits, scrutiny of planning and resources, and discussion with pupils and staff. A brief report goes to the full governing body.

Teachers assess understanding through class discussion, responses to tasks, written or creative work, and self- and peer-assessment. **Assessment is never about testing pupils' personal values, beliefs or family circumstances.** It monitors knowledge, understanding and the development of skills such as empathy, respect and decision-making. Outcomes are recorded in Go4Schools on the school's four-point scale, in line with the wider assessment policy, and used to inform future planning.

The RSE lead evaluates the programme each year in consultation with staff, pupils and parents. This policy and the coverage grid are reviewed each July against current guidance.

16. Resources

Resources are drawn from a range of sources including Christian organisations whose position reflects the school's own, mainstream subject associations, and specialist bodies for safeguarding, first aid and online safety. **All resources are reviewed by the Headteacher against the same standard: factual accuracy, legal correctness, age-appropriateness, and respect for every person.** A resource is not used because of its source; it is used because it meets that standard.

17. Approval and review

This policy is published on the school website and available in hard copy free of charge on request. It is reviewed annually and whenever statutory guidance changes.

Consulted with parents: [autumn term 2026]. Approved by the Governing Body on [date]. Next review: July 2027.

Appendix 1: Parental consultation

In preparation for writing this policy the school held consultation meetings with parents in **October 2019** and **March 2025**. The responses gathered are recorded below verbatim, as given. They are reproduced in full because they are the evidence of consultation and because they continue to shape what is taught and when — see §5, where each is traced to the decision it informs.

A further documented consultation on this version takes place in the autumn term of 2026.

Q1. "All schools may teach about faith perspectives. In particular, schools with a religious character may teach the distinctive faith perspective on relationships." What do you believe to be our distinctive faith perspectives on relationships?

1. One man, one woman, biological gender at birth. 2. Having a Christ-centred marriage. 3. God's vision was perfect for relationships. 4. We should be allowed to teach from a Biblical perspective. 5. No sex outside of marriage. 6. Age-appropriate sex education.

How do these affect what we teach and how we teach it?

1. God created Adam and Eve — the Truth — what God intended. 2. Husband and wife is a permanent relationship/structure and there are extended families. 3. The Fall is what breaks relationships. 4. Friendships: on the

basis of loving your neighbour and enemy; in mutual respect. 5. Without having a personal relationship with God, you can't fully appreciate what being in a relationship is. 6. Relationships are broken by sin. 7. Our identity is in Christ (ideally). 8. There is a unity in the Godhead that can be an example of how we should be in relationships. 9. Marriage is the only context for sexual relationships — not outside marriage. 10. The marriage relationship should be characterised by love and respect. 11. All relationships are examples of the love of God. 12. Being single is also a high calling — model of Paul — counter cultural. 13. The realities of different family units; there should be no stigma attached to different family units. 14. A message of blessings. 15. Love, not homophobic. 16. Mankind is made in the image of God. 17. We teach that the Bible is true because it is God's word. We need to teach our children what is 'right' and what is 'wrong'. 18. 'Husbands love your wives'; 'children obey your parents'.

Q2. At what age do you think it is appropriate to teach children about LGBT?

1. It can be introduced around the ages of 10/11. If a child asks before this age then this should be handled sensitively and in a Biblical way.

How do you think we should tackle this subject?

1. Year 7 — teach identity in Christ; emphasise Christian principles of love and respect: God's love for all people. 2. One to one depending on when children notice and ask questions (this would mean it had to be left largely to parents). 3. A little comment or response can be enough. 4. Better to explain or describe different relationships in a Christian school or classroom environment rather than allowing secular worldviews to shape the children. A number of parents said their children were asking questions about same-sex relationships they had observed in their neighbourhood or on television or films. 5. Transgender should not be referred to until KS3 and taught from the perspective of God. 6. Teach all pupils they are different because of Christ and they are not like the world.

Q3. What do you consider to be the key features of healthy friendships?

1. Respect, love, equal roles, care, putting others ahead of yourself, loyalty, kindness, empathy and consideration for others' feelings. 2. Mutual respect of one another's body, privacy and space. 3. Fruits of the Spirit. 4. Being truthful with each other. Having honesty and integrity. 5. Relationships should be formed naturally — no coercion or agenda and no outside influences.

What range of contexts would you draw attention to?

1. Staff responses. 2. Examples of unity among staff. Difficulty with conflict and examples of how we deal with it. Fruit of the Spirit. Anywhere where young people enter into relationships with adults, e.g. sports, churches, youth groups. 3. Relationships within families. 4. Social media and distance relationships — even across a screen should be healthy.

What do you think are the features of less positive relationships?

1. Bullying, taking but not giving. Using or abusing — physical or emotional. Control, gossip, manipulation, criticism, anger or violence. Selfishness. Unforgiveness and a reluctance to say sorry. 2. Peer pressure that could lead to negative influence in behaviour and actions.

Q4. What do you think is appropriate or inappropriate to teach at Lower School, Middle School and Upper School?

Lower School. 1. Pupils to be taught about the nuclear family as God's way. Different family perspectives to be taught as part of British Values, respect and tolerance. 2. God creates children through the relationship between father and mother. 3. Safety in all forms and consent should be taught from age 4+. 4. Pupils are taught that they have a voice and how to use it if they feel they are in danger. 5. Not appropriate to teach sexual content at this age. 6. 'Keep your hands to yourself' is taught from this age, thus showing respect for personal boundaries.

Middle School. 1. Intimate heterosexual content can be taught, and to learn about the existence of other sexual orientations through a Biblical lens. 2. Puberty, personal care and the implications for their adulthood, particularly menstruation, from Y5 or 6. 3. Relationships and LGBT issues should wait till Upper School in the main. However children should be able to ask questions, even if the answer is that it needs to be discussed separately or with parents at home. 4. Difficult to teach these things with a wide age range in one class.

Upper School. 1. All forms of relationships, including LGBT, but always taught through a Biblical worldview and with love and understanding. 2. Christian marriage and what God put this into place for. 3. How sex was God’s gift to be enjoyed by the human race, and what sin has done to that gift to make dangers like pornography and other sexual practices seem appealing. 4. How boys and girls should treat each other, with respect and appropriate language, not showing bias because of sex, religion, race or disability.

Q5. What knowledge do you feel children need to be able to recognise and report physical and sexual abuse?

1. When someone uses sexually sensitive words towards them. 2. When someone acts in a sexually suggestive manner towards them. 3. When someone touches them in private parts of their bodies suggesting sexual advances. 4. Who is safe to talk to. 5. How to say or shout NO.

Q6. How do you monitor your children’s online involvement?

1. Talk to them about it. 2. Use a computer in an open space. 3. Use filters to prevent access to an unsafe site. 4. Discuss positive as well as negative aspects of online activities. 5. Regulate their screen time. 6. Parents can control their online activity. 7. Schools give specific teaching on pornography and its addictive nature; have a specific person pupils can go to to talk about issues relating to online pornography.

Q7. Do you think mental well-being should be included in our RSE policy?

Yes, from a Biblical viewpoint. No meditation (Zen) or mindfulness practices. Our well-being comes from our creator. No shame attached to mental health issues.

Appendix 2: What has changed in this version

Appendix 1, the record of parental consultation responses from October 2019 and March 2025, is carried forward from the previous policy **unchanged and in full**, as the evidence of consultation. Section 5 is new and traces each parental position to the decision it informs, so that a reader can see the consultation was acted on rather than merely held.

Change	Reason
Rewritten against the July 2025 statutory guidance in place of the 2019 guidance	The 2025 guidance comes into force on 1 September 2026. The previous policy also reached its stated review date in May 2026
Legal basis stated precisely against the two paragraphs that actually bind us — paragraph 2A for Relationships Education and RSE, and paragraph 2(2)(d) for personal, social, health and economic education	Accuracy in both directions. Health Education as the separate statutory subject does not apply to independent schools, but health is named in the PSHE standard that does. Saying only the first would understate the duty; saying only the second would claim a regulation that does not bind us. The policy now states both, and explains that the statutory Health Education content is used as the benchmark for meeting the PSHE standard well
The right of withdrawal corrected. The previous policy said parents may withdraw from “those aspects of sex and relationship education”	That was wider than the law allows. The right applies to sex education only, not to Relationships Education or Health Education. The pupil’s own right to opt in from three terms before turning 16 was also missing
Ten areas of new or strengthened content placed , including AI and deepfakes, misogyny and VAWG, vaping, suicide prevention, legal literacy, and financial harms	All are additions in the 2025 guidance
Parental transparency strengthened: all curriculum materials available on request, with a positive response	A specific requirement of the 2025 guidance. The previous wording offered “opportunities for parents to view the DVDs and resources”

Change	Reason
The seven principles of the 2025 guidance mapped against our provision	They are the framework the guidance is now built on
Misogyny and body-image teaching separated. In the previous policy, teaching boys not to mistreat girls and encouraging girls to resist pressure about their appearance sat in consecutive paragraphs	Both are good teaching. Placed together, a reader could infer a connection between how a girl presents herself and how she is treated. They are now in different places, with responsibility for abuse stated to lie with the person who commits it
Sex, gender and the law rewritten. Removed: the “watch and wait” formulation, an unsourced statistic, and reliance on a 2017 external guidance document. Added: what is taught as fact, and the guidance’s requirement not to present contested beliefs as established fact	Currency and legal accuracy. This section carries a recommendation for specialist legal review before adoption
Singleness honoured alongside marriage	Scripture honours it, and a programme presenting marriage as the only good outcome fails the pupils who will not marry
Class and phase structure updated to Willow, Hazel, Oak, Maple, Birch, Ash and Cedar	The previous policy described the 2025/26 arrangement, including a note that there was one Year 11 pupil
Schemes of work replaced by the Growing in Christ strand and phase structure, with the coverage grid referenced	The topic cycles described in the previous policy are superseded from 1 September 2026
New sections: SEND accessibility; resources and how they are vetted; the three rules for contested issues	Gaps in the previous version
New §5, Age and stage , setting out what is taught at what age, with each decision traced to its basis — parental consultation or statutory requirement	The previous policy contained these age decisions but scattered them between §6:4, the appendix and the schemes of work, where they were easy to lose. They are now in one place and can be checked at a glance
Puberty is stated as taught to Years 5 and 6 together, not split by year group	The March 2025 consultation was explicit — teach it at Y5 and 6 “and not to split the class up”. The Growing in Christ architecture and coverage grid currently specify a year-specific block and must be corrected to match
Menstrual wellbeing taught to all pupils, not girls only	Statutory Health Education requires it for all pupils. The consultation recorded it as being taught to girls; this is a change to the school’s practice and is flagged as such
Zen meditation and mindfulness practices recorded as not used	A clear parental position from March 2025 that was not previously written into the policy
A distinction added at §7 between teaching convictions as true and not presenting genuinely contested questions as settled	The guidance’s requirement not to present contested views as fact, placed near the school’s own convictions, could be read as demoting those convictions to opinion. It does not, and the policy now says so
Vision statement corrected to “Growing in Christ. Thriving in Learning. Shaping the Future.”	The 2025 policy carried the school’s former vision. This is the current one
Section numbering repaired; “Version 1” page headers removed; an incomplete sentence in the gender section completed	The previous policy mixed 1.0 and 1:1 numbering, skipped section 2.0, and contained a sentence that stopped mid-clause